

* `[!characters]` will match any characters that are not listed. For example, `[!ab].rar` will match `c.rar` but not `a.rar` or `b.rar`.

Hacking with Sudo

Sudo allows you to run a command with root privileges. The default installation of Ubuntu includes the Sudo command (`sudo`) and gives the default user account access to this command. If you need something to run as root, you can use `sudo`. A related command, `sudoedit`, allows you to edit a file as root. For example, to edit the root-only file `/var/spool/anacron/cron.daily`, you can use either of the following commands:

```
sudo vi /var/spool/anacron/cron.daily
sudoedit /var/spool/anacron/cron.daily
```

Some history

When Unix was young (circa 1970), administrators needed a way to change between user access privileges. This was accomplished with the `su` command. Although originally designed to switch user access, it was mainly used to change privileges from a regular user to root. (The `su` command is sometimes called the super-user command for this reason.)

There are a couple of huge risks with using `su` to run commands as root. Most notably, all commands are executed with root privileges. Many times, only one command within a long list of commands really needs root access. Also, when a terminal is logged in as root, users may forget which user they are running as. Accidentally deleting files from a directory as root can be much more devastating than doing so as a regular user.

Sudo was created to limit the commands that can run as root. Rather than changing all privileges, only the privileges for a specific command are changed. Furthermore, Sudo can even limit which commands can be run as root. When the command completes, you are back to your regular user access. This way, only the required steps run as root, and you won't accidentally leave a terminal logged in as root.

Although very old Unix systems still rely on `su` to change access levels, it is being forcefully replaced by `sudo`. Furthermore, in most BSD and Linux distributions (including Ubuntu), Sudo has become standard for using root privileges. Although the `su` command is included with the Ubuntu installation, you cannot use it to run commands as root unless you first set a root password using `sudo passwd root`.

Adding Users to Sudo

The configuration file for `sudo` is `/etc/suders`. This lists who can run commands as root, which commands they can run, and any configuration preferences. Although this file can be edited using `sudo vi /etc/sudoers`